



CANON — INSTITUTIONAL KNOWLEDGE CORPUS

Document ID: SH-J2-CANON-001 | **Version:** 1.0.0 | **State:** LOCKED

Owner: Orientation | **Related:** Judgment, EIB, Semaphore, temporal integrity, provenance | **Cross-reference:** TEMPORAL_INTEGRITY.md; PROVENANCE_AND_LINEAGE.md; AI_AUTHORITY_AND_HUMAN_AUTHORSHIP.md

Canon means: **what Sable Harbor can responsibly say it knows at this point in time.** It is living, versioned current best understanding, not eternal certainty; uncertainty can itself be canonical. Orientation owns Canon and Judgment supplies much of its analytical basis.

For a material change, one Orientation Officer authors the proposed institutional change and a second reviews/stress-tests it. If material disagreement cannot be resolved, the Head/Director of Orientation breaks the deadlock. There is no standing Canon committee. Every superseded state remains accessible with time, evidence, dissent, and change reason.

“We know this now”

Canon gives Sable Harbor an explicit present-tense institutional read. It prevents the company from hiding behind permanent ambiguity while also refusing false certainty. A canonical statement may say that evidence is incomplete, confidence is bounded, interpretations remain disputed, or an important question is unresolved. Those are institutional knowledge states, not editorial failures.

Canon distinguishes observation, evidence, warranted judgment, adopted institutional understanding, assumption, and unknown. It does not transform an authoritative source for one purpose into universal physical truth. A ledger may canonically establish what was recorded; it may not establish what physically occurred without additional evidence.

Entry and material change

Judgment commonly supplies analytical basis, but a judgment does not automatically become Canon. The originating Orientation Officer states the proposed knowledge change, prior state, evidence and provenance, confidence, material dissent, scope, effective time, and downstream consequences. A second officer independently stress-tests it. The Head resolves a material editorial deadlock without becoming a czar of truth.

Materiality depends on whether the change could alter important enterprise questions, decisions, finance assumptions, operating models, risk envelopes, education, or interpretation of prior events—not word count or executive interest.

Supersession and intellectual history

A new state links to the one it supersedes. The former state remains accessible with the evidence and reasoning then available. Later explanation is layered as later knowledge. Canon never silently backfills history or deletes a dissent because one view eventually prevailed.

Downstream owners receive notice or discoverable linkage when a material Canon change affects an EIB item,

decision, model, control, course, or live Judgment Problem. Orientation owns the institutional knowledge state; accountable operating functions still own their decisions and execution.

Negative authority

Canon is not a command, vote, legal conclusion beyond its sources, or substitute for operating accountability. Daedalus cannot write or promote itself into Canon. No committee votes truth into existence, and no executive can make evidence settled merely by repeating it.

Controlled publication • Generated from docs/j2/alexandria/CANON_INSTITUTIONAL_KNOWLEDGE.md • Do not alter PDF manually